Skilled Independent visa (subclass 189)

Points-tested stream

This visa lets invited workers with skills we need, to live and work permanently anywhere in Australia.

When you have this visa

- Coming to Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-0)*
- In Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-1)*
- Leaving Australia *(#haveThisVisa-index-2)*

Coming to Australia

If you are outside Australia when the visa is granted, you must enter Australia before a date that we specify on your visa grant letter.

Before you leave

Check your travel documents

You must have:

- a valid visa to enter Australia
- a valid passport or other travel document

At the border

Complete an Incoming Passenger Card

All people arriving in Australia must complete the Incoming Passenger Card *(https://www.abf.gov.au/entering-and-leaving-australia/crossing-the-border/at-the-border/incoming-passenger-card-(ipc))*. You will be given this card onboard.

Leaving the airport faster

We have an automated process that uses facial recognition technology and your ePassport. You might be able to leave the airport faster if you use SmartGates *(http://www.abf.gov.au/smartgates)*.

In Australia

- stay in Australia permanently
- work and study
- enrol in Australia's public health care scheme, Medicare *(http://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/medicare)*
- sponsor your relatives to come to Australia
- travel to and from Australia for 5 years
- if eligible, become an Australian citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*

What you must do on this visa

You and your family members must obey Australian laws.

How long you can stay

This is a permanent visa. It lets you stay in Australia indefinitely.

Travelling on your visa

You can travel to and from Australia for 5 years from the date we grant the visa. After 5 years you will need a Resident Return (RRV) visa (subclass 155 or 157) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)* to re-enter Australia as a permanent resident. To see when the 5 years ends, use VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/)*.

New Zealand passport holders

If an immigration officer processes your clearance at our border, we recommend you tell them:

- you have a Skilled Independent visa (subclass 189)
- you do not want a Special Category visa (subclass 444)

If you don't tell them, you might be granted a subclass 444 visa. Grant of a subclass 444 visa will cease your permanent visa, which will then affect your eligibility for Australian citizenship.

Proving you have a visa

To prove you have a visa and show your conditions to someone, use VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/)*.

Working

You are protected by Australian workplace law. See your workplace rights and entitlements. *(https://www.fairwork.gov.au/how-we-will-help/templates-and-guides/fact-sheets/rights-and-obligations/visa-holders-and-migrant-workers-workplace-rights-and-entitlements)*

Bringing family

As an Australian permanent resident, you might be able to sponsor eligible family to come to Australia.

To find a visa for your family member, explore visa options *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-finder)*.

Becoming an Australian citizen

After a certain time, you might be eligible for Australian citizenship. Find out more about becoming a citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*.

For citizenship purposes, your permanent residence starts on the day:

- we granted the visa, if you were in Australia
- you entered Australia on this visa, if you were outside Australia when we granted it

Leaving Australia

Before you leave

Check your travel documents

You must have a valid passport or other travel document to leave Australia and return.

Ensure your visa is still valid and allows you to re-enter Australia

Check the travel component of your visa in VEVO *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/)*.

See what to do if your visa has expired or is about to expire *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

At the Border

Leaving the airport faster

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After you leave

Proving you have been to Australia

Request your international movement records *(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/entering-and-leaving-australia/request-movement-records)* to get proof of your travel in and out of Australia.